



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय
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— Tantravārttika, Chapter 20, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

It speaks of two things connected, where one's quality as dharma is clearly understood. The other, because it serves the first, isn't recognized as dharma in itself. Think of it like this: the breath sustains the body, but we don't typically consider the breath itself as a form of righteousness. Its value is derived from its service to the body, which is engaged in dharma.

The scripture continues by pointing out that things with a beginning, like grammar, can't inherently be dharma, especially for those already learned in usage. Vedic scriptures, the very foundation of dharma, don't rely on grammar for their authority. The Vedas existed and conveyed profound truths long before formal grammar was established. Their power comes from their inherent spiritual resonance, not linguistic rules.

Applying this wisdom to our modern lives, we can see how easily we get caught up in the external structures of things, mistaking the means for the end. We might focus on the rituals of religion without truly understanding the underlying compassion and wisdom. We might obsess over the perfect yoga pose without cultivating inner peace. The Tantravārttika reminds us to look beyond the surface, to seek the source of true dharma within ourselves and in the timeless wisdom of the Vedas. Don't get lost in the grammar of life; find the essential truth that it points to. The true dharma isn't in the perfect articulation, but in the intent and the connection to the divine. It is about recognizing that some things are intrinsically valuable, while others serve to support that intrinsic value. Focus on the intrinsic, and let the supporting structures fall into place naturally. Your spiritual practice should be a journey towards this inner truth, not a rigid adherence to external forms.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

Are you prioritizing the outward expressions of your spiritual practice over the inner transformation it is meant to foster, and how can you re-center yourself on the true source of dharma within?